acquaintances are strictly confined to the performances of their official duties only.

(g) Persons deployed in the operation of cyphers should be extremely careful of the dangerous influence of alcoholic drinks, that so often lowers moral standards. They should strictly avoid all social contacts with persons who are anxious to entertain them in any surreptitious manner.

As time passed, the job of the spies became even more gruelling. Many spies believe that certain documents related to crucial operations should be distributed among fresh recruits to help them learn the craft of the trade and lessons from triumphs and failures. In the early 1980s, the R&AW was a rising star in the global intelligence community and hundreds of Indian spies worked across the world in often hostile environments to harvest information with the potential to change the course of the future. Back in the Delhi headquarters, analysts were busy with 'for your eyes only' reports for the customers. Here are some nuggets gleaned from the R&AW.

Iran-Iraq Conflict

On 22 September 1980, ayear after the Islamic revolution in Iran, Iraq, governed by Saddam Hussein, invaded the fragile Iran led by the religious leader, Ayatollah Khomeini. The Islamic Republican Party (IRP) of Iran that was born amidst the revolution in 1979 was averse to the ceasefire proposal hurriedly drafted by the Islamic Summit, a coalition of several Islamic countries. R&AW spies picked up intelligence from field agents on the conflict that destabilised the region and slowly but surely, turned Khomeini into Iran's godfather. Three months after the war, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) created an Islamic Cell: a separate administrative division to